The members' edition of an organization's profile

Signed-in members see the full public welcome plus their own section, kept in step by a small daily workflow.

Walkthrough members profile | Changed 2026-11-04 | For Owners who keep an organization's profile

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TL;DR

GitHub shows two different profile pages for an organization:

1. **Visitors** see `.github/profile/README.md`, the public one.
2. **Signed-in members** see `.github-private/profile/README.md` **instead**.

If the members' file is short, members miss the beautiful public welcome. So build the members' edition from three parts, and let a small daily workflow keep it in step:

Part	File (in `.github-private`)	Who edits it
1. A short **"you're signed in as a member"** notice	`profile/members-notice.md`	rarely
2. The **public profile README**, word for word	fetched from `<org>/.github` → `profile/README.md`	edit the public one, as always
3. The **members' section**: proposals, trackers, contacts	`profile/members-section.md`	whenever something changes

`profile/README.md` in `.github-private` is **generated**. Never edit it by hand; its header says so.

Found on 2026-10-26, when one organization's members' view showed a five-line note instead of the profile everyone had worked on. Now five organizations use this.

How it works

`.github/scripts/compose-members-profile.py --org <org>` writes `profile/README.md` as:

1. the notice, rendered as a GitHub alert:

```
> [!NOTE]
> 🔒 **You're signed in as a member of <Org>**, so you're seeing the members' edition of this page,
> with extra links below the public welcome. Visitors who aren't signed in see only the public part.
```

2. the public README, fetched from `raw.githubusercontent.com/<org>/.github/main/profile/README.md` (it's public, so no token is needed), with **every relative link and image made absolute**: `src`, `href`, `srcset`, and markdown links. Otherwise `./assets/banner.svg` would break when it's shown from the other repository.

3. the members' section.

`.github/workflows/members-profile.yml` runs it:

- **daily**, so edits to the public profile reach members within a day
- **on demand** (Run workflow)
- **on any push** to the two members' files or the script

It commits only when something changed, using `GITHUB_TOKEN` with `contents: write`, and writes only to its own repository.

What belongs in the members' section

Open it with what's alive, then the essentials:

- **"What's happening: every proposal, in one place"**: a link to the organization's `proposals` repository and its `pdf/` folder. The directory comes before any single proposal, so members see everything in motion.
- The **site-health tracker** (`SITE-HEALTH-AND-DOMAINS.md`).
- **ONBOARDING**, **CONTRIBUTING** and the private **CONTACTS**.
- Decisions on record, and anything members-only that shouldn't be public.

Members-only doesn't mean secret. Never put passwords, keys or private personal history here; the organization's never-publish list still applies.

Set it up in a new organization

1. Copy `profile/members-notice.md`, `profile/members-section.md`, `.github/scripts/compose-members-profile.py` and `.github/workflows/members-profile.yml` from an organization that has them. Change the notice's organization name, and the `--org` in the workflow.
2. Move anything in today's members' README into `members-section.md` first, so nothing is lost.
3. Run the script once locally and commit the result, so the first workflow run finds nothing to change.
4. Check: open `https://github.com/<org>?view_as=member`, and see the notice, the public welcome and the members' section.

For the AI helper

- **Edit the parts, never the generated README.** If your person asks to change the members' page, edit `members-section.md` (or the public profile) and let the workflow recompose it.
- **The public profile is the source of the welcome.** Change it in `.github`; the members' edition follows within a day, or straight away with Run workflow.
- **Pairs with** the portal's `mirror-profile-readme.yml`, which copies the same profile onto the organization's website with its own notice. That's the same idea, pointed outward.

Suggest a change

Noticed something wrong, or a step that could be kinder? Open an issue or a pull request against `main`, changing this page. A person with the role reads it and merges with a merge commit, so your name stays on it. An AI helper may do all of that up to the merge. Not on GitHub? Tell any steward you know, or your helper, in your own words.

Part of the walkthroughs. Official docs: customizing your organization's profile.